

Exercise: The elements of a data story

Introduction

You have gained a thorough understanding of data storytelling, its components and how to craft a compelling story from your raw data. You have learned how a strong narrative drives the storyline while effective visualizations and appropriate charts are at the heart of story presentations and grab the audience's attention.

In this exercise, you are asked to review the dataset provided, create a narrative story, and present it in the form of a report in Microsoft Power BI. This exercise helps you develop your storytelling skills, which are essential to convey insights effectively.

Scenario

Adventure Works, a multinational bicycle manufacturer, has sales operations across the globe. The company's CEO wants to look at the growth of the company in terms of revenue and profit to devise its strategic directions for future years. That is your narrative.

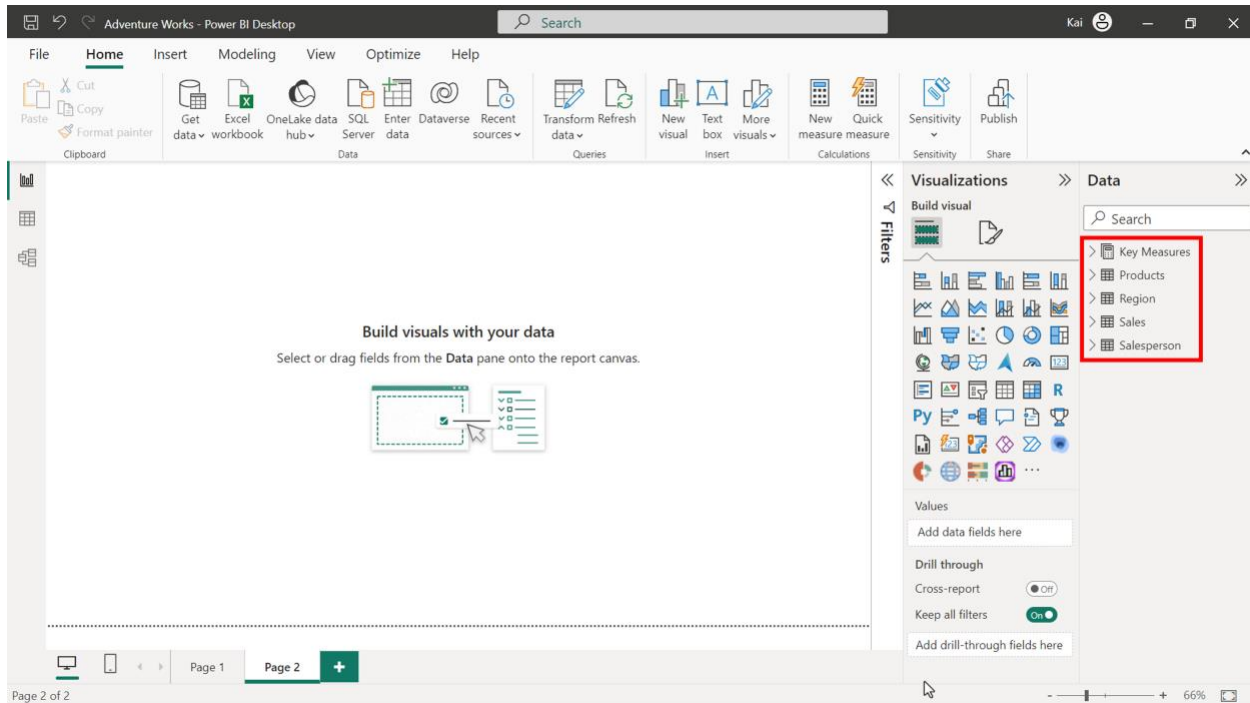
Follow these exercise steps to craft a compelling data story about the growth of the company.

By completing this exercise, you will demonstrate your ability to:

- Review the dataset and identify the measures needed to support your story.
- Create a multi-page report in Power BI desktop and include appropriate charts that clearly present your data story.
- Identify insights you can convey to the CEO and other stakeholders in your story.

Step 1: Download the Power BI project file.

1. Download and save the Power BI project *Adventure Works data story.pbix*.
2. Open the file in Power BI desktop. Notice that the dataset includes five tables; **Key measures**, **Products**, **Sales**, **Region**, and **Salesperson**.



Step 2: Explore the data and identify which elements you need to visualize.

1. Explore the dataset tables and measures. Identify which fields and measures you need to include to support your story of growth and which of them you can use to create visualizations in the report canvas.
2. Identify the items from the **Key measures** table that will be the key highlights and the most valuable information for the CEO.

Tip: You need to remember the narrative of the story while exploring the data. For example, you can consider **yearly sales** and **previous year sales** to indicate the difference.

Tip: You can also consider the **total revenue** and **profit** as the most valuable information and as key highlights of the presentation.

Step 3: Create a report in Power BI desktop to present your story.

1. Create a chart showing revenue and revenue from the previous year. Take time to consider the most appropriate chart type for this data before adding it to the canvas.
2. Create another chart showing **Revenue YoY%** which shows the company's growth over the years in terms of sales.
3. Create visuals to present key information such as profit, revenue, and growth. Again, take time to consider which Power BI visuals you are selecting and why they are the most appropriate.

Tip: You can use the **Accessible city park theme** to create consistency in colors.

Tip: A bar or column chart are appropriate chart types for revenue and growth analysis.

Tip: You can use card visuals to display the key metrics.

Step 4: Format your visualization and craft the story.

1. Format the charts for consistent font style, color schemes, and scaling.
2. Organize your findings and highlights on the canvas to structure a coherent narrative.
3. Add a title as the beginning of the story before concluding your story by providing a conclusion or recommendation.

Tip: You can add an additional text box at the end of the report to contain the conclusion.

Tip: It is good practice to create and format one card visual and then copy and paste it to create others. This ensures a consistent appearance for all the cards.

Step 5: Provide insights from your data story.

- Add the insights and takeaways that are evident from your story about Adventure Works growth to the report.

Tip: You can write your insights on the same or separate report page.

Step 6: Save your project.

- Save your Power BI project to your computer.

Tip: Make sure you provide an appropriate path for your project.

Conclusion

With these steps you have successfully created a cohesive and informative narrative for the CEO. You identified the most important measures to use as the basis for the visualizations in your report. You then presented these using the most appropriate chart types to display the information. Finally, you were able to present important insights that will assist the CEO in planning for the future.